Masoumeh "Marya" Rahimi

Graduate Research Assistant
Department of Learning Sciences
Georgia State University

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Learning Sciences, Georgia State University, Atlanta, Georgia, July 2027 (expected). Doctoral Student Fellow, Snap Inc. Center for Computer & Teacher Education. GPA: 4.11/4. (Lauren E. Margulieux, Chair)
M.Sc.	Computer Science, Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran, October 2018. GPA: 17.58/20 (among the top 10% in class). Thesis, "Minimum Stretch Spanning Trees in 3-Tree Graphs." Grade: Excellent. (Maryam Tahmasbi, Advisor)
B.Sc.	Computer Science, University of Isfahan, Isfahan, Iran, February 2015.

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

2023–Present	Graduate Research Assistant, Snap Inc. Center for Computer & Teacher Education, Georgia State University, Atlanta, Georgia.

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026	**Outstanding Ph.D. Student in Learning Technologies Award**, Department of Learning Sciences, College of Education & Human Development, Georgia State University.
2025	**SIGCSE 2025 Best Paper Award**, Computing Education Research Track, 56th ACM SIGCSE Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education.
2025	**POOIA 2025 Student Excellence Award**, Professional Organization of Iranian Americans, in recognition of sustained academic excellence.

SCHOLARSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Publications

Refereed Journal And Conference Articles

1. Darling-Aduana, J., **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L., & Liao, Y. C. (2026). Students' AI relational identity: Conceptualization and applications. *Frontiers in Education, 11*, Article 1873025. https://doi.org/10.3389/feduc.2026.1873025

2. Liao, Y.-C., **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L., & Darling-Aduana, J. (2026). Cultivating AI-ready practices: The interplay of teacher adaptation, professional growth, and school leadership support. *GATEways to Teacher Education, 35*(1), 14–34.

3. Margulieux, L. E., **Rahimi, M.**, Liao, Y. C., Haddadian, N., Parker, M., & Calandra, B. (2025). Comparisons between and trends among integrated computing activities designed by teachers and researchers. In *Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Conference on International Computing Education Research V. 1* (pp. 284–297). https://doi.org/10.1145/3702652.3744221

4. Falkner, N. J. G., Parker, M. C., Altin, R., Börstler, J., Krause-Levy, S., Kunz, K., Maniapoto, T., Petersen, A., **Rahimi, M.**, Satavlekar, S., & Sibia, N. (2025). Cards for alternative research design (CARD): Refining and evolving a research knowledge development activity for computer science education. In *2025 Working Group Reports on Innovation and Technology in Computer Science Education* (pp. 1–60). https://doi.org/10.1145/3760545.3783969

5. **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L. E., Towell, D., Calver, J., Loksa, D., & Prather, J. (2025). The impact of students' views of failure on performance in introductory programming courses. In *Proceedings of the 30th ACM Conference on Innovation and Technology in Computer Science Education V. 1* (pp. 611–617). https://doi.org/10.1145/3724363.3729112

6. Margulieux, L., Prather, J., & **Rahimi, M.** (2025). The biological benefits of failure on learning and tools to manage the fallout. *Educational Psychology Review, 37*(2), Article 33. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10648-025-10013-7

7. **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L. E., & Anderson, E. (2025). CS concepts and contextual factors in integrated computing activities in US schools. In *Proceedings of the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 1* (pp. 931–937). https://doi.org/10.1145/3641554.3701817

8. Margulieux, L. E., Prather, J., **Rahimi, M.**, & Uzun, G. C. (2023). Leverage biology to learn rapidly from mistakes without feeling like a failure. *Computing in Science & Engineering, 25*(2), 44–49. https://doi.org/10.1109/MCSE.2023.3297750

Refereed Conference Abstracts

1. **Rahimi, M.**, Parker, M. C., & Krause-Levy, S. (2026). Playing with cards for alternative research design (CARD). In *Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education, Vol. 2* (p. 1706). https://doi.org/10.1145/3770761.3777100

2. Falkner, N. J. G., Parker, M. C., Altin, R., Börstler, J., Krause-Levy, S., Kunz, K., Maniapoto, T., Petersen, A., **Rahimi, M.**, Satavlekar, S., & Sibia, N. (2025). Exploring, refining and evolving a research knowledge development activity for computer science education. In *Proceedings of the 30th ACM Conference on Innovation and Technology in Computer Science Education, Vol. 2* (pp. 689–690). https://doi.org/10.1145/3724389.3731284

3. **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L. E., Prather, J., Uzun, G. C., & Kimmel, B. (2023). Benefits of failure on neuroplasticity and tools for persistence. In *Proceedings of the 2023 ACM International Computing Education Research Conference, Vol. 2* (pp. 5–6). https://doi.org/10.1145/3568812.3603470

Conference Workshops and Interactive Sessions

1. Parker, M. C., Krause-Levy, S., & **Rahimi, M.** (2026, February). *Playing with cards for alternative research design (CARD)* [Birds of a Feather session]. 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE), St. Louis, MO.

2. **Rahimi, M.** & Haddadian, N. (2025, October). *Project-based learning in IT classrooms* [Workshop]. Innovate IT Conference, Fulton Innovation Academy, Alpharetta, GA.

Conference Presentations

1. **Rahimi, M.** (2026, February). *Failure in context: Designing multidimensional supports for diverse introductory programming students*. Presentation at the 4th Annual Graduate Conference for Research, Scholarship, and Creative Activity, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

2. **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L. E., & Anderson, E. (2025, February). *CS concepts and contextual factors in integrated computing activities in U.S. schools*. Paper presented at the 56th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education (SIGCSE), Pittsburgh, PA.

3. **Rahimi, M.**, Margulieux, L. E., & Anderson, E. (2024, October). *Integrated computing presentation*. Presentation at the Lunch and Learn Series, Department of Learning Sciences, Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA.

4. **Rahimi, M.**, & Tahmasbi, M. (2019, January). *Minimum average stretch spanning trees in 3-tree graphs*. Paper presented at the 4th Conference on Contemporary Issues in Computer and Information Sciences, Kharazmi University, Tehran, Iran.

Professional Development Provided

1. **Rahimi, M.** (2020, December). *Introducing games to boost cognitive skills in preschool*. Cognitive Skills Workshop, Mehr-e-Tahaa NGO, Tehran, Iran. Invited workshop for 40 preschool teachers from Hamoon County.

2. **Rahimi, M.** (2020). *Assessing the needs of kindergarten teachers in suburban areas of Zabol*. Participatory Workshop, Zabol, Sistan and Baluchestan, Iran. Facilitated a two-day workshop with more than 30 kindergarten teachers.

3. **Rahimi, M.**, Khosravi, M. Darvishpour, Sh. (2019, October). *Integrating games with mathematics for elementary educators*. Teacher Development Workshop, Dishmook, Kohgiluyeh and Boyer-Ahmad, Iran. Designed and presented a one-day workshop for more than 40 teachers.

Non-Refereed Scholarly Products

1. **Rahimi, M.**, Darling-Aduana, J., Liao, Y.-C., & Margulieux, L. E. (2025). *Evaluation of the AI-ready pilot at Seckinger High School* [Internal report]. Gwinnett County Public Schools.

2. **Rahimi, M.**, Darling-Aduana, J., Liao, Y.-C., & Margulieux, L. E. (2025). *The AI-ready pilot at Seckinger High School* [External report]. Gwinnett County Public Schools.

3. Margulieux, L. E., **Rahimi, M.**, & Anderson, E. (2024). *Programming and computational thinking concepts and contextual factors in integrated computing activities in U.S. schools* [Data set]. Dryad. https://doi.org/10.5061/dryad.ttdz08m6v

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Georgia State University, Atlanta, Georgia
Instructional Designer; *Computational Thinking*, *Cybersecurity and Privacy*, *Computer Systems*, *Networks and the Internet*, *Computer Applications and Data*, *Field Experience* 2026
Designed 6 self-paced online courses for PK–12 teachers pursuing Georgia's Computer Science Endorsement.

Mofid Elementary School, Tehran, Iran
Lead Teacher; *Computer Science Curriculum for Elementary Students* 2021–2022
Designed curriculum and supported teachers in integrating computing into their instruction and teaching computing concepts to their students.

Teacher; *Block-Based Programming Course, Grades 5–6* 2019–2021
Taught a project-based programming course in which students developed programming skills through hands-on projects.

Codynick, Tehran, Iran — Project-Based Coding and STEAM Education Program
Teacher; *Creative Thinking Course, Grades 5–6* 2020
Designed and taught a four-month project-based programming and IoT course in which students identified real-world problems, programmed sensor and actuator widgets, developed STEM solutions, and prepared projects for a national science fair.

CAFCO, Tehran, Iran — K–12 Educational Organization
Teacher; *Learning Math Through Games, Grades P–3* 2019–2020
Designed and taught activities that introduced foundational mathematics concepts through games and mathematical puzzles.

Teacher; *Algorithmic Thinking* 2019–2020
Designed and taught hands-on activities using educational robots including Codey Rocky and Edison to help students develop algorithmic thinking and problem-solving skills.

Shahid Beheshti University, Tehran, Iran
Teaching Assistant; *Computational Geometry, Graduate* 2017–2018
Led recitation sessions for two semesters focused on reviewing course concepts and solving problems; also held office hours and graded assignments.

Teaching Assistant; *Graph Theory, Undergraduate* 2018
Held office hours and graded assignments under the supervision of Professor F. Sheikhi.

Facilitator; *How to Teach Online* 2017–2019
Supported university faculty and students in using online teaching technologies, including creating and managing online courses and presenting course materials through the university's e-learning system.

SERVICE

Service to the Profession: Peer Review

2026	**Manuscript Reviewer**; *ACM Transactions on Computing Education*
2026	**Manuscript Reviewer**; *Computer Science Education*
2026	**Program Committee Member**; ACM International Computing Education Research (ICER).
2025, 2027	**Reviewer**; ACM SIGCSE Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education

Service to the University and College of Education and Human Development

2026 **Judge**; Georgia State Undergraduate Research Conference, Georgia State University. Evaluated four undergraduate oral research presentations at the 20th annual university-wide research conference

2026 **Mentor**; Learning Sciences Graduate Student Association (LS-GSA) Mentorship Program, College of Education and Human Development, Georgia State University. Mentoring three graduate students on research, academic writing and publishing, networking, program navigation, and professional development.

Service to the Profession: Other

2026 **Co-Director**; West Point STEAMfest. Organize a community STEM event featuring hands-on activities in coding, robotics, music computing, and e-textiles.

2025 **Bronze Judge**; Technovation Girls. Evaluated five technology-based projects

2025 **Mentor**; NCWIT AiC-WA + NSF IAMCS Paired Mentoring Program. Provided structured mentoring to one undergraduate from the University of Waterloo and one graduate student from Gannon University

2025 **Mentor**; International Learning Sciences Student Association (ILSSA) Mentoring Program. Mentored a Ph.D. student from the University at Buffalo

2020 **Program Committee Member**; Symposium on Empowering the Underprivileged Through Education, Sustainable Development School, Sharif University of Technology, Iran

2020 **Program Committee Member**; Workshop Series on Rural Education, Mehr-e-Tahaa NGO, Tehran, Iran. Served on the program committee for workshops focused on rural preschool education

VOLUNTEER WORK

2025 **Pilot Developer**; Smarties Early Childhood Learning Center, Atlanta, Georgia. Designed and implemented a six-week early childhood robotics and computer science pilot using Edison robots.

2025 **Panelist**; World Cultures Day, St. Martin's Episcopal School, Atlanta, Georgia. Engaged Grades 4–8 students in discussions of cultural diversity and Kurdish culture.

2025 **Student Speaker**; AMIS Welcome Reception, Atlanta, Georgia. Delivered a welcome address to more than 300 newly arrived international students.

2024 **Fundraising Volunteer**; Child Foundation, USA. Supported fundraising for educational opportunities for children in Iran.

2024 **Instructor**; Persian Cultural Center of Atlanta. Taught a weekly computational thinking course for Pre-K and elementary students.

2023–2026 **Volunteer Member**; Georgia Iranian Students Organization (GISO), Georgia. Assisted with community and cultural events.

2019 **Facilitator and Consultant**; Women and Youth Entrepreneurship Development Foundation, Iran. Supported the transition of nationwide classes to online delivery and trained instructors and learners in online learning tools.

2015–2023 **Co-Organizer and Mentor**; Negel Village, Kurdistan, Iran. Raised more than $5,000 for the village library, mentored more than 50 K–12 students, and organized over 20 STEM and soft-skills courses.